



TASK 3 – INTRODUCTION

CHAPTER CONTENTS.

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What questions can you answer with causal mapping?

What kind of object is a causal map and how do you answer questions with it?

The chapter after this one, [Individual questions — introduction](#), is a catalogue: one page for each question you can put to a causal map.

A map you can query

Coding narrative data leaves you with a table of links. A table can be interrogated. See [Causal mapping produces models you can query to answer questions](#) and [The product of \(causal\) qualitative coding can be a model you can query](#).

[Outputs of QDA](#) puts causal mapping alongside other QDA approaches.

What follows from what

A map shows that somebody said A influenced B, and somebody said B influenced C. Whether you may go on to say that A influences C is a venerable argument: [The most controversial feature of causal maps is transitivity](#) and [The transitivity trap](#).

Beyond transitivity, [Ways to causal inference](#) surveys the routes that lead from a map to a claim about the world. [We can reason about causal maps using a logic of evidence](#). [Causal maps are knowledge graphs, but with wings](#) connects this business to the knowledge-graph literature.

Whether to believe the answer

Every query returns some result or other. Whether that answer is worth putting in a report depends on several things. [Quality assurance at each step of the causal coding workflow](#) works through the workflow stage by stage. [Assessing quality or robustness of evidence for a causal link based on a bundle of coterminous causal claims](#) narrows down to a single link and asks how strongly it is supported.

Finally, [Automating the standard questions — slide creation functions](#) shows how MapCat and the Causal Map app can help you decide which analyses you need, and run them for you.

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 **Outputs of QDA**

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